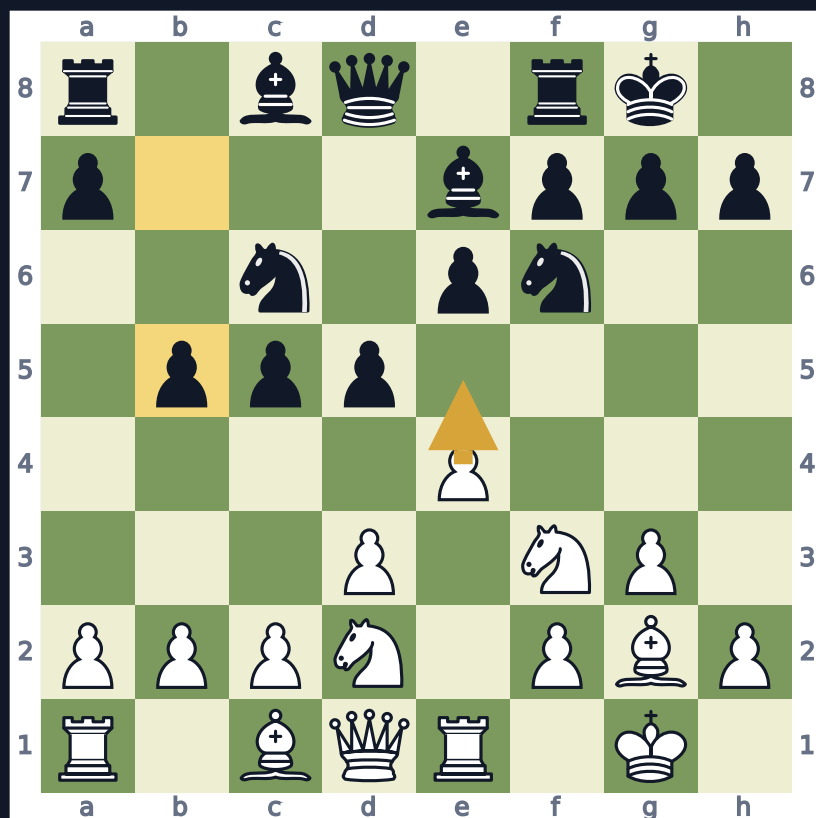


03

The KIA Piece Routes

Nbd2-f1-h2-g4, the g2 bishop, and how every backward move must name a destination.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will stop imitating famous maneuvers and begin choosing routes according to the target and Black's counterplay.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 013 | PAGE 4

Decode: The d2 knight goes to f1

A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

LESSON 014 | PAGE 8

Play: The d2 knight goes to f1

A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

LESSON 015 | PAGE 12

Decode: The h2-g4 attacking route

The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

LESSON 016 | PAGE 16

Play: The h2-g4 attacking route

The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

LESSON 017 | PAGE 20

Decode: The g2 bishop behind the chain

A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

LESSON 018 | PAGE 24

Play: The g2 bishop behind the chain

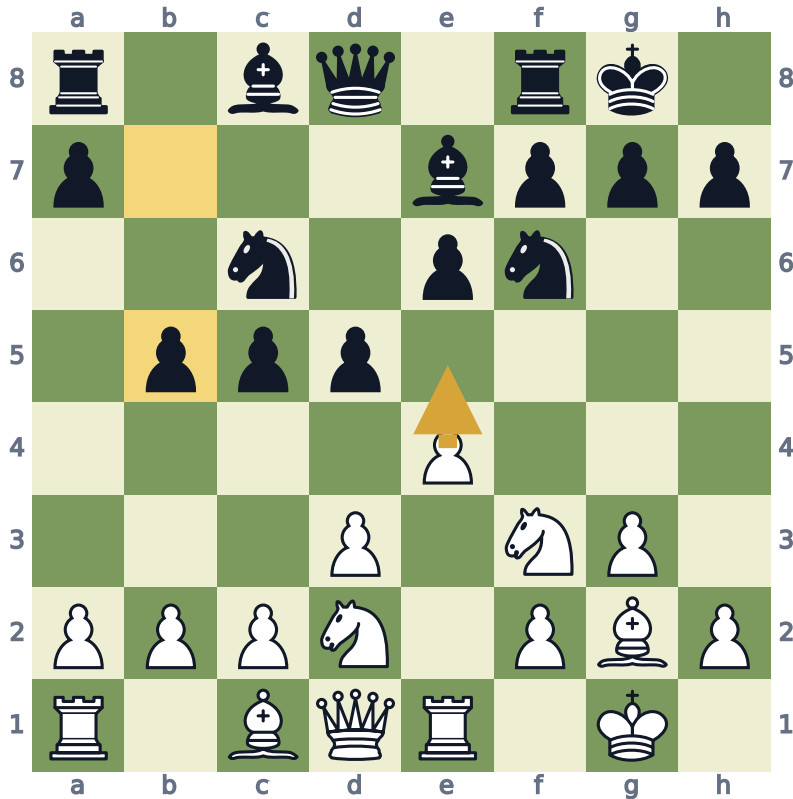
A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

VOLUME OBJECTIVE

You will stop imitating famous maneuvers and begin choosing routes according to the target and Black's counterplay.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The d2 knight goes to f1



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo.

DECISION RULE

What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses the maneuvering time for ...b4, ...a5-a4, or ...f6 and tries to make the knight's destination irrelevant.

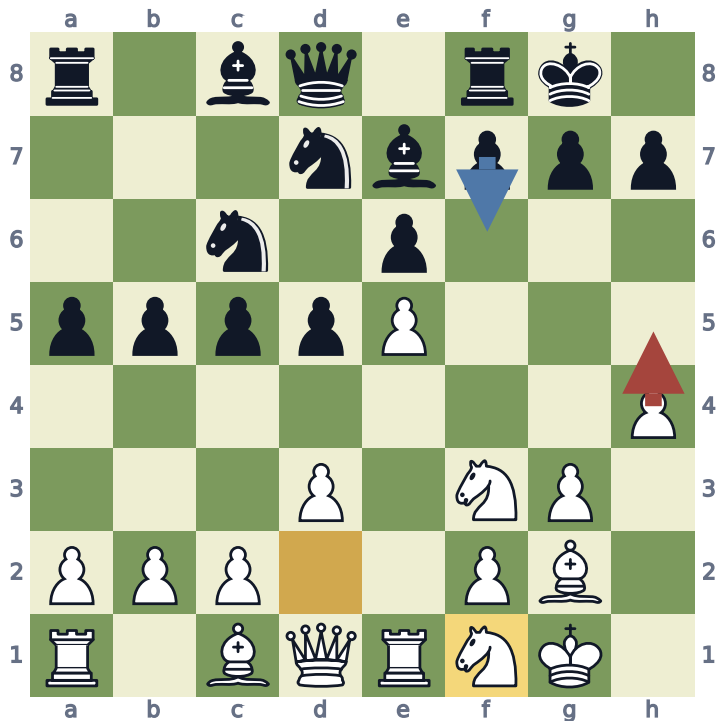
WHITE'S PLAN

White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense.

MEMORY RULE | A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black uses the maneuvering time for ...b4, ...a5-a4, or ...f6 and tries to make the knight's destination irrelevant.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense.

FAILURE MODE

Playing Nf1 because it is thematic when e3, h2, and g3 are all poor destinations.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

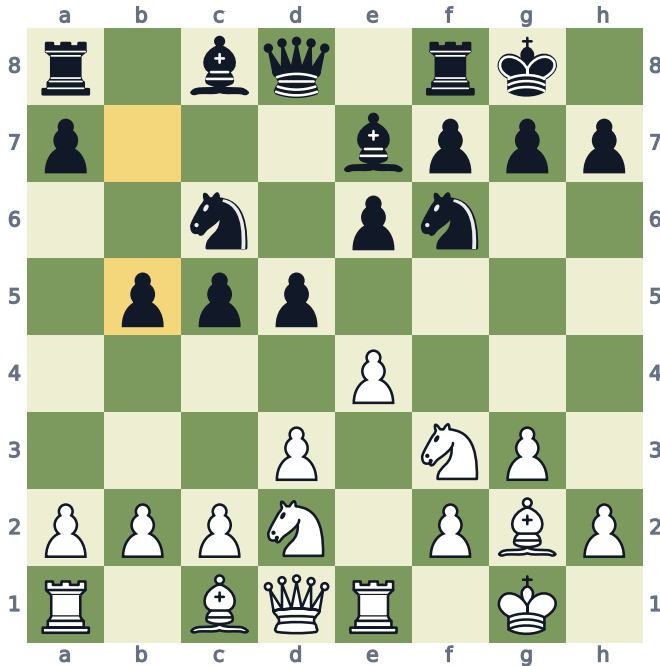
RULE | A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey? White's attacking or positional plan is: White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense. The line fails as a template when: Playing Nf1 because it is thematic when e3, h2, and g3 are all poor destinations.

STORE THIS | A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

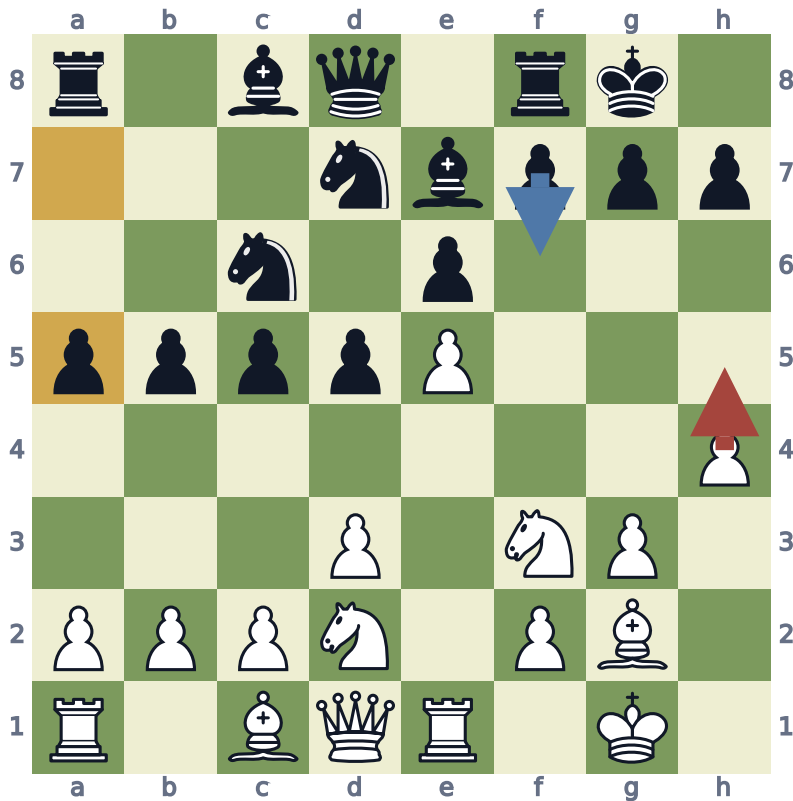
1. Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo. 2. Black uses the maneuvering time for ...b4, ...a5-a4, or ...f6 and tries to make the knight's destination irrelevant. 3. White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense. 4. What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey? 5. Playing Nf1 because it is thematic when e3, h2, and g3 are all poor destinations.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The d2 knight goes to f1



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo.

DECISION RULE

What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses the maneuvering time for ...b4, ...a5-a4, or ...f6 and tries to make the knight's destination irrelevant.

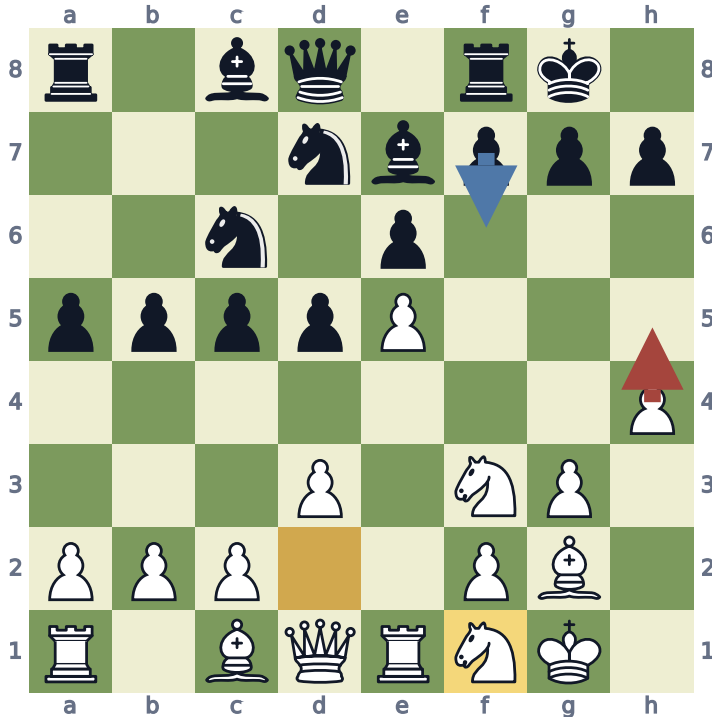
WHITE'S PLAN

White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense.

MEMORY RULE | A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black uses the maneuvering time for ...b4, ...a5-a4, or ...f6 and tries to make the knight's destination irrelevant.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense.

FAILURE MODE

Playing Nf1 because it is thematic when e3, h2, and g3 are all poor destinations.

DECISION TEST

Ask: What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

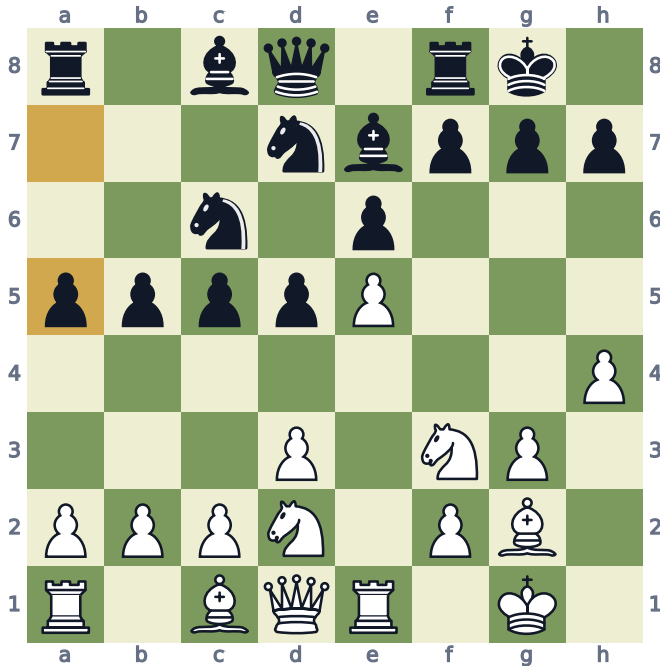
RULE | A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1



- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey? White's attacking or positional plan is: White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense. The line fails as a template when: Playing Nf1 because it is thematic when e3, h2, and g3 are all poor destinations.

STORE THIS | A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

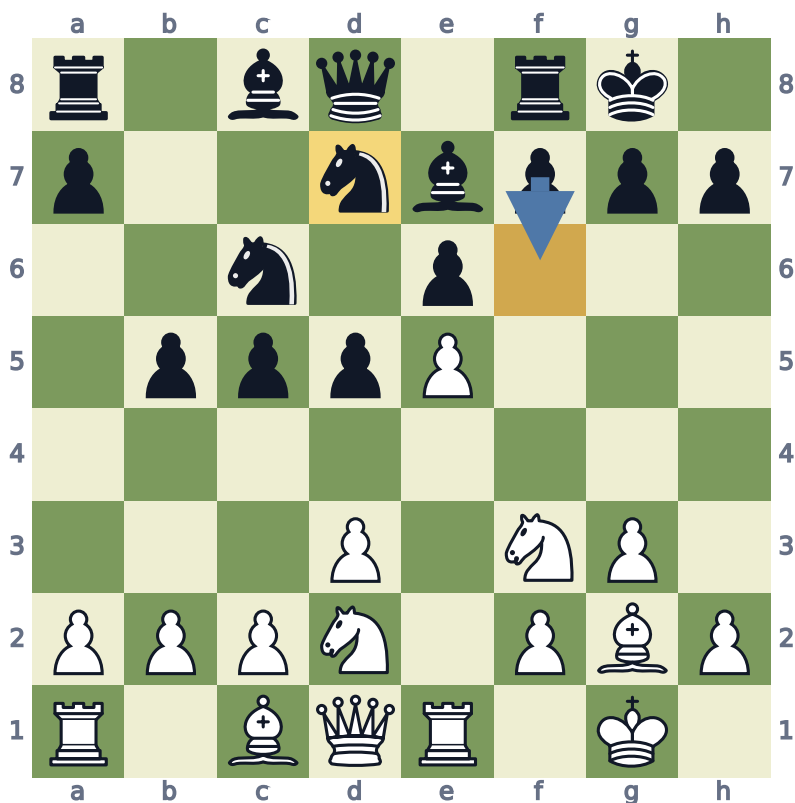
1. Nf1 clears d2, protects h2, and prepares h2-g4 or e3, but it temporarily reduces queenside influence and costs a tempo. 2. Black uses the maneuvering time for ...b4, ...a5-a4, or ...f6 and tries to make the knight's destination irrelevant. 3. White routes the knight only when h2, g4, or e3 contributes to the actual attack or central defense. 4. What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey? 5. Playing Nf1 because it is thematic when e3, h2, and g3 are all poor destinations.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The h2-g4 attacking route

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn.

DECISION RULE

After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black challenges the knight with ...h5 or ...f5, opens the center, or attacks d3 before the kingside pieces settle.

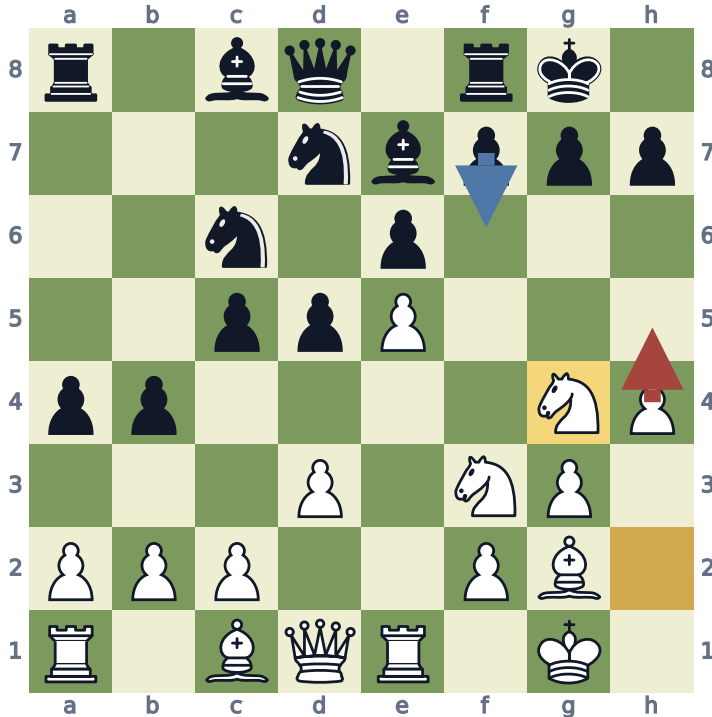
WHITE'S PLAN

White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat.

MEMORY RULE | The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black challenges the knight with ...h5 or ...f5, opens the center, or attacks d3 before the kingside pieces settle.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat.

FAILURE MODE

Completing the long route when the g4 knight can be chased without creating a weakness.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

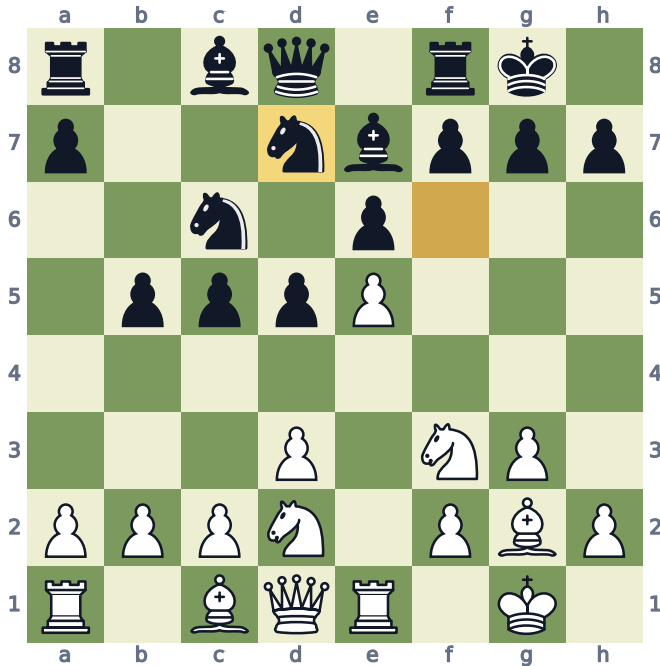
RULE | The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. Ng4



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away? White's attacking or positional plan is: White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat. The line fails as a template when: Completing the long route when the g4 knight can be chased without creating a weakness.

STORE THIS | The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

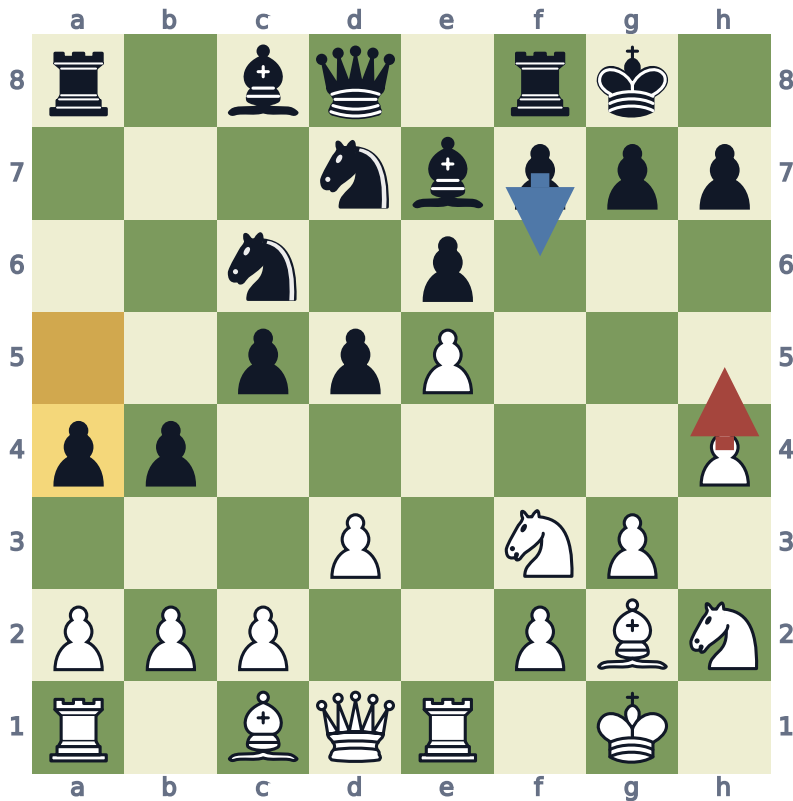
1. The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn. 2. Black challenges the knight with ...h5 or ...f5, opens the center, or attacks d3 before the kingside pieces settle. 3. White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat. 4. After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away? 5. Completing the long route when the g4 knight can be chased without creating a weakness.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The h2-g4 attacking route



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn.

DECISION RULE

After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black challenges the knight with ...h5 or ...f5, opens the center, or attacks d3 before the kingside pieces settle.

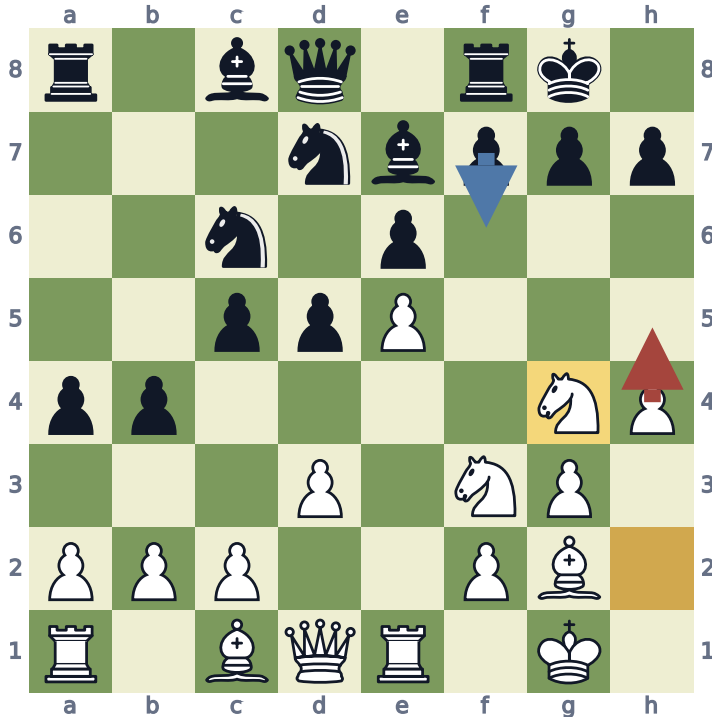
WHITE'S PLAN

White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat.

MEMORY RULE | The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black challenges the knight with ...h5 or ...f5, opens the center, or attacks d3 before the kingside pieces settle.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat.

FAILURE MODE

Completing the long route when the g4 knight can be chased without creating a weakness.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

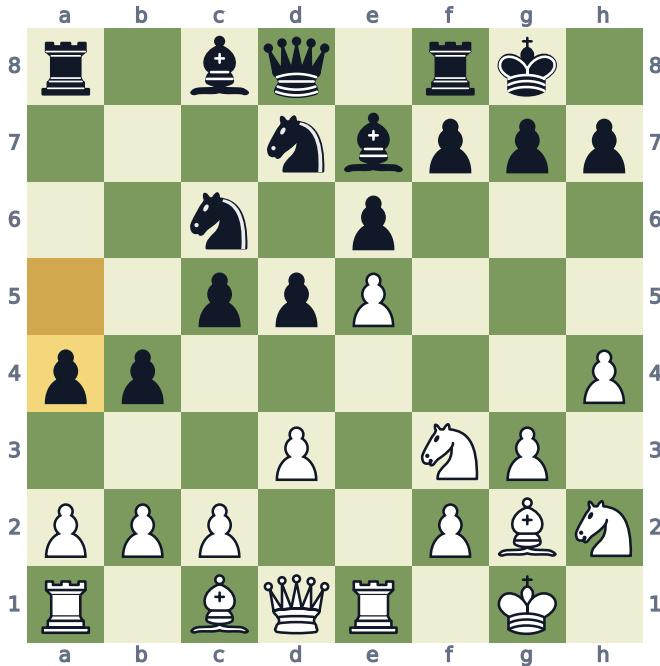
RULE | The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. Ng4



- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- N1h2: White reroutes a knight to h2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- a4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away? White's attacking or positional plan is: White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat. The line fails as a template when: Completing the long route when the g4 knight can be chased without creating a weakness.

STORE THIS | The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

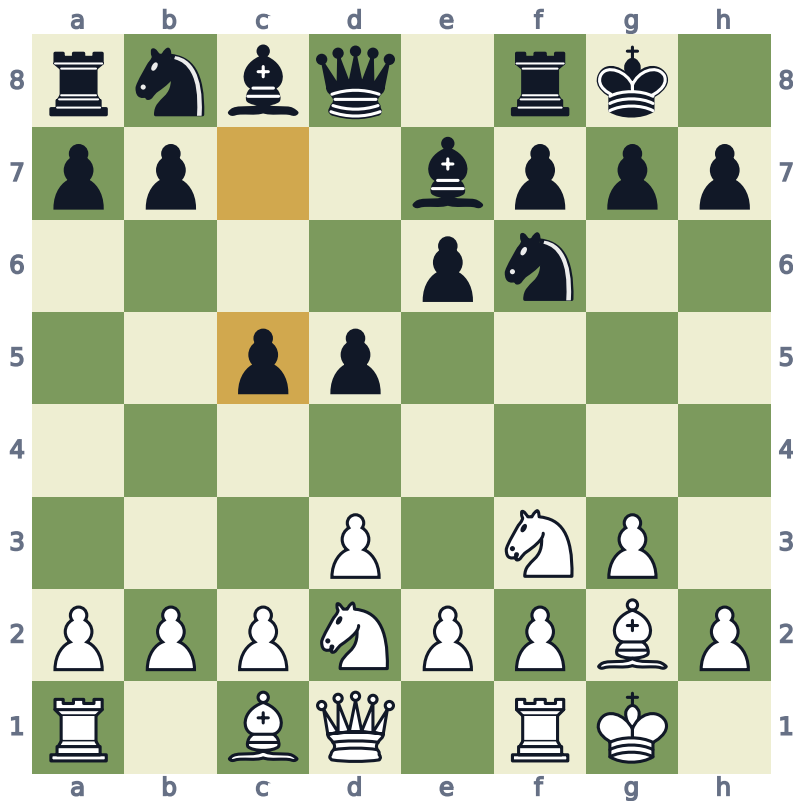
1. The knight from f1 can reach h2 and g4, where it attacks f6 and h6 and supports a kingside pawn break without blocking the g-pawn. 2. Black challenges the knight with ...h5 or ...f5, opens the center, or attacks d3 before the kingside pieces settle. 3. White coordinates Ng4 with h5, Bf4, and queen entry squares so the knight's arrival creates a concrete threat. 4. After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away? 5. Completing the long route when the g4 knight can be chased without creating a weakness.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 24 plies from memory, then replay: 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The g2 bishop behind the chain



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation.

DECISION RULE

Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the diagonal closed, uses d4, and seeks queenside play while White's bishop has no direct target.

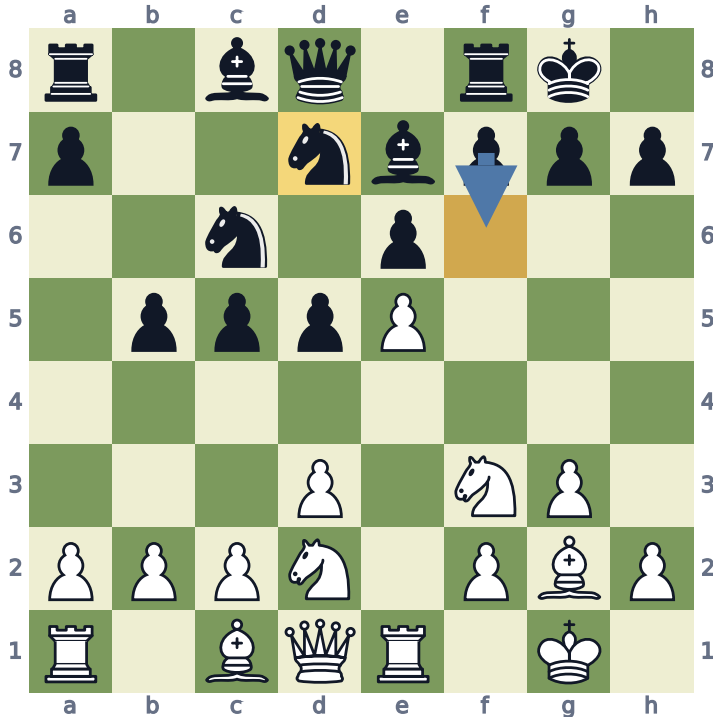
WHITE'S PLAN

White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army.

MEMORY RULE | A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black keeps the diagonal closed, uses d4, and seeks queenside play while White's bishop has no direct target.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army.

FAILURE MODE

Forcing the diagonal open merely to justify the bishop while conceding the stronger central structure.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

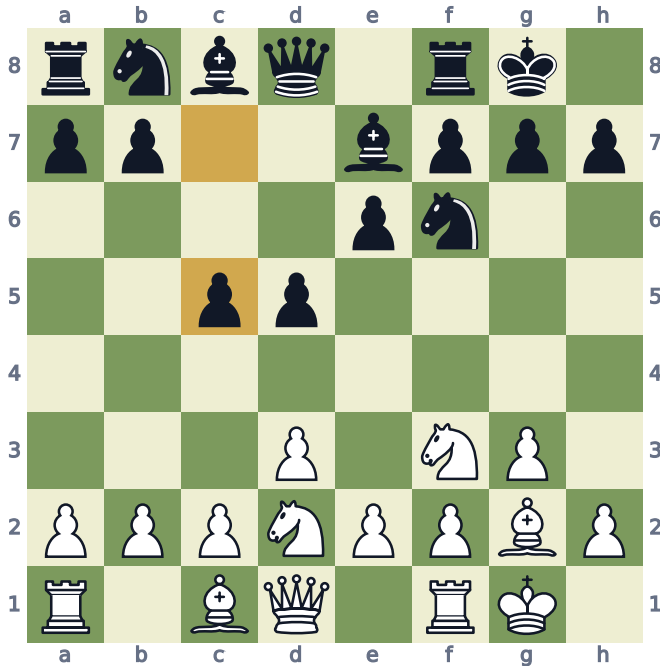
RULE | A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- d3: White supports e4 and keeps the center compact at the cost of space on d4.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nbd2: White reroutes a knight to d2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center? White's attacking or positional plan is: White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army. The line fails as a template when: Forcing the diagonal open merely to justify the bishop while conceding the stronger central structure.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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ANSWER KEY

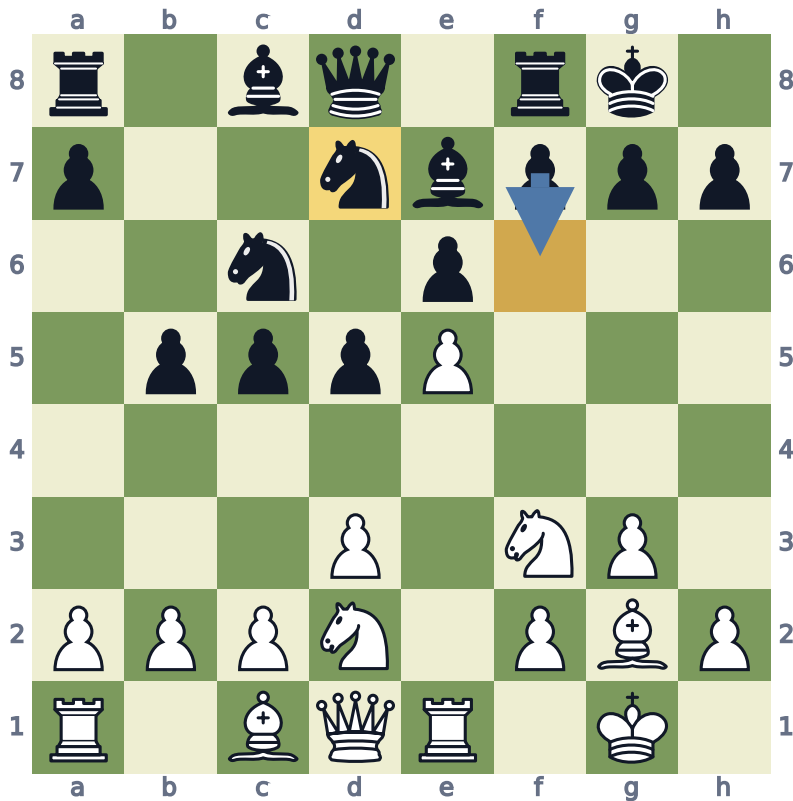
1. The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation. 2. Black keeps the diagonal closed, uses d4, and seeks queenside play while White's bishop has no direct target. 3. White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army. 4. Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center? 5. Forcing the diagonal open merely to justify the bishop while conceding the stronger central structure.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The g2 bishop behind the chain



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation.

DECISION RULE

Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the diagonal closed, uses d4, and seeks queenside play while White's bishop has no direct target.

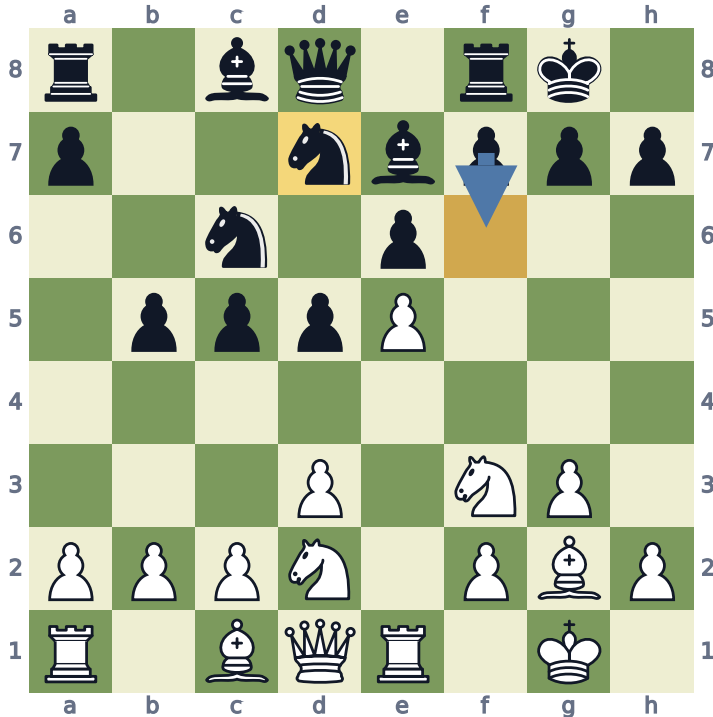
WHITE'S PLAN

White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army.

MEMORY RULE | A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black keeps the diagonal closed, uses d4, and seeks queenside play while White's bishop has no direct target.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army.

FAILURE MODE

Forcing the diagonal open merely to justify the bishop while conceding the stronger central structure.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

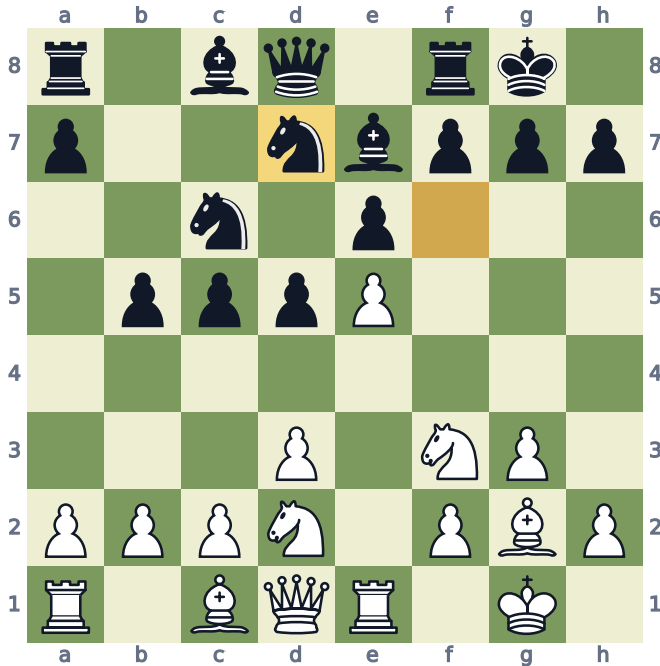
RULE | A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7



- e4: White builds the KIA center but must account for Black's immediate central break.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center? White's attacking or positional plan is: White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army. The line fails as a template when: Forcing the diagonal open merely to justify the bishop while conceding the stronger central structure.

STORE THIS | A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. The g2 bishop may appear blocked by e4, but it protects the king, supports central dark squares, and can awaken after e5-e6, exd5, or a queenside transformation. 2. Black keeps the diagonal closed, uses d4, and seeks queenside play while White's bishop has no direct target. 3. White judges the bishop by its defensive and latent value, then opens the diagonal only when the center change helps the entire army. 4. Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center? 5. Forcing the diagonal open merely to justify the bishop while conceding the stronger central structure.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 013 Decode: The d2 knight goes to f1

Prompt: What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey?

Recall: A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

LESSON 014 Play: The d2 knight goes to f1

Prompt: What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey?

Recall: A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

LESSON 015 Decode: The h2-g4 attacking route

Prompt: After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away?

Recall: The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

LESSON 016 Play: The h2-g4 attacking route

Prompt: After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away?

Recall: The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

LESSON 017 Decode: The g2 bishop behind the chain

Prompt: Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center?

Recall: A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

LESSON 018 Play: The g2 bishop behind the chain

Prompt: Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center?

Recall: A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The d2 knight goes to f1

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1

Decision: What exact square will the f1 knight occupy next, and what useful move can Black make during the journey?

Memory: A retreat is an investment; write the destination and job before paying the tempo.

CARD 2

The h2-g4 attacking route

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. Ng4

Decision: After Ng4, what target is attacked twice and what defensive pawn move can drive the knight away?

Memory: The h2-g4 route works when the knight's arrival forces a concession.

CARD 3

The g2 bishop behind the chain

1. Nf3 d5 2. g3 Nf6 3. Bg2 e6 4. O-O Be7 5. d3 O-O 6. Nbd2 c5 7. e4 Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

Decision: Which pawn move would activate the bishop, and would that move improve or expose White's center?

Memory: A fianchetto bishop can be valuable while hidden; open it when the position, not the ego, demands it.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
013 Decode: The d2 knight goes to f1	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
014 Play: The d2 knight goes to f1	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
015 Decode: The h2-g4 attacking route	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
016 Play: The h2-g4 attacking route	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
017 Decode: The g2 bishop behind the chain	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
018 Play: The g2 bishop behind the chain	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.